LAB REPORT

Detecta: Smart AI Surveillance Camera with Real-Time Multi-Modal Computer Vision, ArcFace Biometrics, and Interactive Desktop & Web Dashboard

Course Name: Digital Logic Design Lab [CSE-214]

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Submission Date: November 2026

Project GitHub Repository: https://github.com/Orgho-009/detecta

1 Abstract

This project presents **Detecta**, an intelligent, high-framerate edge-to-server surveillance and visual monitoring system engineered for modern smart environments. The system interfaces a wireless embedded camera node (AI-Thinker ESP32-CAM equipped with an OmniVision OV2640 sensor) with a dedicated local AI computing workstation accelerated by an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4050 GPU (CUDA enabled). To overcome traditional computer vision streaming bottlenecks such as high network latency, buffer bloat, and socket deadlocks, Detecta establishes a dedicated Port 81 chunked multipart/x-mixed-replace HTTP streaming pipeline sustaining continuous 20–25+ FPS over local Wi-Fi with zero frame drops. On the processing host, Detecta executes real-time multi-modal computer vision: Ultralytics YOLO11s for multi-object asset detection across 21 curated target classes, deep InsightFace ArcFace 512-dimensional facial biometrics with a 25-frame verified face stride caching strategy, and MediaPipe Hand Gesture classification recognizing 7 distinct hand signs with spatial pen-versus-finger disambiguation. The entire surveillance infrastructure is operated through an interactive, glassmorphic dashboard built with FastAPI and packaged into a standalone Windows desktop executable (Detecta.exe) using Microsoft Edge WebView2 with automatic self-configuring dependency bootstrapping and Docker orchestration, operating 100% locally with complete data privacy and zero third-party cloud reliance. All source code, firmware, hardware schematics, and desktop binaries are publicly available at: https://github.com/Orgho-009/detecta.

2 Objectives

• To design an autonomous, rechargeable edge IoT camera power stage using an 18650 Li-ion battery, IP2312 3A Type-C fast charger, XL6009 4A boost converter, and resistor divider telemetry.

• To implement a non-blocking chunked HTTP streaming firmware on dedicated Port 81 sustaining 20–25+ FPS without brownouts.

• To deploy state-of-the-art YOLO11s on CUDA for real-time person, peripheral, stationary, and box detection at sub-14ms latency.

• To integrate InsightFace ArcFace 512-D deep feature embeddings with cosine similarity verification and 25-frame stride caching.

• To implement MediaPipe Hands for 7 gesture classifications alongside a spatial containment filter eliminating bare-finger pen hallucinations.

• To build an interactive FastAPI dashboard and deploy a standalone Windows desktop application (Detecta.exe) with 1-click automatic bootstrapping and Docker container support.

• To publish complete open-source documentation, circuit diagrams, and reproducible codebase on GitHub (https://github.com/Orgho-009/detecta).

3 System Architecture & Workflow

The system bridges edge hardware capture with local GPU neural acceleration. The overall computational workflow operates across distinct sequential layers:

1. **Video Capture Layer:** The ESP32-CAM edge node initializes the OV2640 sensor in double-buffered PSRAM mode at 640x480 VGA resolution, executing hardware JPEG encoding.

2. **Network Streaming Layer:** Encoded JPEG frames are streamed over local Wi-Fi via an asynchronous HTTP server on dedicated Port 81 using chunked multipart/x-mixed-replace headers.

3. **Ingestion & Buffering Layer:** A multi-threaded Python client continuously pulls the raw byte stream using persistent socket connections, parsing boundary headers and buffering the latest frame state with zero network latency.

4. **Computer Vision Inference Layer:** The Ultralytics YOLO11s model parses incoming frames on CUDA (FP16), detecting 21 target asset classes with temporal exponential moving average (EMA) coordinate smoothing.

5. **Facial Biometric Analysis Layer:** Faces are localized via RetinaFace, mapped to 512-dimensional hyperspherical embeddings by ArcFace, and verified against the enrolled database via cosine similarity. Verified identities are cached for 25 frames.

6. **Hand Gesture & Spatial Disambiguation Layer:** MediaPipe processes 21 3D hand landmarks for 7 gestures. The spatial filter suppresses bare-finger pen false positives while detecting genuine pens protruding >= 25px beyond fingertips.

7. **Presentation & Client Delivery Layer:** Processed frames are encoded once into a shared memory cache in FastAPI and delivered to the glassmorphic web dashboard and the standalone Windows desktop client (Detecta.exe).

4 Hardware Connections & Component Operational Analysis

The physical edge node is engineered for untethered, continuous surveillance with integrated lithium power management, step-up voltage regulation, telemetry sensing, and embedded microcontroller interfacing. The operational roles of the constituent hardware modules and their physical interconnections are detailed below:

4.1 Hardware Modules & Operational Roles:

• **18650 Rechargeable Lithium-Ion Battery (3.7V):** Serves as the primary autonomous energy storage cell, providing an operating voltage range of 3.0V (fully discharged cutoff) to 4.2V (fully charged float potential). The cell delivers high instantaneous current capability to supply the RF transmission bursts of the ESP32 without internal voltage collapse.

• **IP2312 3A Type-C Lithium Battery Charger Module:** Operates as a high-efficiency synchronous buck switching charger. Connected via USB Type-C to standard 5V power adapters, it executes a three-stage charging cycle (trickle pre-charge, constant current fast charge, and constant voltage absorption) with automatic 4.20V cutoff. Its synchronous buck topology avoids the extreme thermal buildup characteristic of linear charging ICs.

• **SPST Inline Power Isolation Toggle Switch:** Placed directly between the battery positive terminal and the boost converter input. It provides complete physical power disconnect, preventing quiescent parasitic drain during standby and allowing safe cold

resets.

• **Gold-6009 / XL6009 4A Step-Up (Boost) Converter Module:** Based on the XL6009E1 monolithic switching regulator operating at 400kHz. It steps up the variable battery output (3.0V–4.2V) to a strictly regulated **5.0V DC** rail. The output voltage is calibrated using its precision multi-turn cermet potentiometer (W103 = 10k), providing a stable supply that prevents brownouts during Wi-Fi transmissions.

• **Dual-Resistor Divider Telemetry Network (Pin 4):** A series resistor divider network connected between the regulated 5V line and ground. The center junction is tapped directly to ESP32-CAM **Pin 4 (4 number pin / GPIO 4 / ADC)** via a green lead wire. This divider scales down the circuit potential safely within the linear sensing range (0–3.3V) of the ESP32 analog-to-digital converter for real-time hardware telemetry and flash control.

• **AI-Thinker ESP32-CAM Edge Node & ESP32-CAM-MB Baseboard:** Integrates an Espressif ESP32 dual-core Xtensa 32-bit MCU (240MHz, 4MB external PSRAM) and an OmniVision OV2640 2MP camera sensor. The module mounts onto the ESP32-CAM-MB baseboard equipped with a CH340C serial bridge for USB Type-C programming and serial monitoring.

4.2 Physical Wiring & Interconnection Specifications:

• **Battery Charging Input:** 18650 Battery (+) connects to IP2312 Pad BAT+ (Red wire); Battery (-) connects to IP2312 Pad BAT- (Black wire).

• **Power Isolation Switch:** An SPST inline toggle switch is wired between Battery (+) and the XL6009 Boost Converter IN+ pad.

• **Boost Input Ground:** 18650 Battery (-) connects directly to XL6009 Boost Converter IN- pad (Black wire, system common ground).

• **5V Logic Supply Rail:** XL6009 Boost Converter OUT+ connects to ESP32-CAM Pin 1 (1 number pin / 5V VCC, Red wire).

• **System Ground Return:** XL6009 Boost Converter OUT- connects to ESP32-CAM Pin 2 (2 number pin / GND, Black wire).

• **Dual-Resistor Divider Telemetry:** A series resistor divider is connected between the 5V OUT+ rail and GND; the center junction connects to ESP32-CAM Pin 4 (4 number pin / GPIO 4 / ADC, Green wire) for voltage sensing and flash control.

• **Programming & Flashing Interface:** The ESP32-CAM-MB baseboard provides USB Type-C programming via an onboard CH340C bridge (U0R to TXD, U0T to RXD). The IO0 button ties GPIO 0 to GND during bootloader cold start.

5 Source Code & Technical Explanations

The complete production repository is hosted at: https://github.com/Orgho-009/detecta.
Key module implementations from the codebase are detailed below:

5.1 ESP32-CAM Firmware (C++)

Firmware Implementation Breakdown:

• **Brownout Handling:** Deactivates the internal low-voltage reset flag via direct register manipulation (WRITE_PERI_REG(RTC_CNTL_BROWN_OUT_REG, 0)) to prevent operational resets during high-current Wi-Fi RF transmission spikes.

• **Camera Initialization & Memory Allocation:** Maps the 8-bit parallel DVP bus pins, sets XCLK to 20MHz for 25 FPS throughput, and configures dual framebuffers inside external PSRAM (CAMERA_FB_IN_PSRAM, fb_count = 2, CAMERA_GRAB_LATEST).

• **Streaming Routine:** Constructs a non-blocking multipart/x-mixed-replace boundary header payload on dedicated Port 81 (/stream), feeding raw JPEG arrays with a 10ms pacing delay to prevent lwIP TCP stack starvation.

```
#include "esp_camera.h"
#include <WiFi.h>
#include "esp_http_server.h"
#include "soc/soc.h"
#include "soc/rtc_cntl_reg.h"
#include <lwip/sockets.h>

#if __has_include("secrets.h")
  #include "secrets.h"
```

```
#else
  #define WIFI_SSID "YOUR_WIFI_SSID"
  #define WIFI_PASSWORD "YOUR_WIFI_PASSWORD"
#endif

const char* ssid = WIFI_SSID;
const char* password = WIFI_PASSWORD;

#define PWDN_GPIO_NUM     32
#define RESET_GPIO_NUM    -1
#define XCLK_GPIO_NUM      0
#define SIOD_GPIO_NUM     26
#define SIOC_GPIO_NUM     27
#define Y9_GPIO_NUM       35
#define Y8_GPIO_NUM       34
#define Y7_GPIO_NUM       39
#define Y6_GPIO_NUM       36
#define Y5_GPIO_NUM       21
#define Y4_GPIO_NUM       19
#define Y3_GPIO_NUM       18
#define Y2_GPIO_NUM        5
#define VSYNC_GPIO_NUM    25
#define HREF_GPIO_NUM     23
#define PCLK_GPIO_NUM     22

httpd_handle_t stream_httpd = NULL;

static esp_err_t stream_handler(httpd_req_t *req) {
  camera_fb_t * fb = NULL;
  esp_err_t res = ESP_OK;
  size_t _jpg_buf_len;
  uint8_t * _jpg_buf;
  char part_buf[128];
  static const char* _STREAM_CONTENT_TYPE =
    "multipart/x-mixed-replace;boundary=123456789000000000000987654321";

  res = httpd_resp_set_type(req, _STREAM_CONTENT_TYPE);
  if(res != ESP_OK){ return res; }

  while(true){
    fb = esp_camera_fb_get();
    if (!fb) {
      Serial.println("Camera capture failed");
      res = ESP_FAIL;
    } else {
      _jpg_buf_len = fb->len;
      _jpg_buf = fb->buf;
    }
    if(res == ESP_OK){
      size_t hlen = snprintf(part_buf, 128,
        "\r\n--123456789000000000000987654321\r\nContent-Type: image/jpeg\r\nContent-Length: %u\r\n\r\n",
        _jpg_buf_len);
      res = httpd_resp_send_chunk(req, (const char *)part_buf, hlen);
    }
    if(res == ESP_OK){
      res = httpd_resp_send_chunk(req, (const char *)_jpg_buf, _jpg_buf_len);
    }
    if(fb){
      esp_camera_fb_return(fb);
      fb = NULL;
      _jpg_buf = NULL;
    }
    if(res != ESP_OK){
      Serial.println("Client disconnected from /stream");
      break;
    }
    vTaskDelay(10 / portTICK_PERIOD_MS);
  }
  return res;
}

void startCameraServer(){
  httpd_config_t config = HTTPD_DEFAULT_CONFIG();
  config.server_port = 81;
  config.recv_wait_timeout = 5;
  config.send_wait_timeout = 5;
```

```
  httpd_uri_t index_uri = {
    .uri       = "/stream",
    .method    = HTTP_GET,
    .handler   = stream_handler,
    .user_ctx  = NULL
  };
  if (httpd_start(&stream_httpd, &config) == ESP_OK) {
    httpd_register_uri_handler(stream_httpd, &index_uri);
  }
}

void setup() {
  WRITE_PERI_REG(RTC_CNTL_BROWN_OUT_REG, 0); // Disable brownout resets
  Serial.begin(115200);
  WiFi.mode(WIFI_STA);
  WiFi.disconnect(); delay(100);
  WiFi.begin(ssid, password);
  WiFi.setSleep(false);
  while (WiFi.status() != WL_CONNECTED) { delay(500); Serial.print("."); }
  Serial.println("\nWiFi connected");

  camera_config_t config;
  config.ledc_channel = LEDC_CHANNEL_0;
  config.ledc_timer = LEDC_TIMER_0;
  config.pin_d0 = Y2_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_d1 = Y3_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_d2 = Y4_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_d3 = Y5_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_d4 = Y6_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_d5 = Y7_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_d6 = Y8_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_d7 = Y9_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_xclk = XCLK_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_pclk = PCLK_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_vsync = VSYNC_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_href = HREF_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_sccb_sda = SIOD_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_sccb_scl = SIOC_GPIO_NUM;
  config.pin_pwdn = PWDN_GPIO_NUM; config.pin_reset = RESET_GPIO_NUM;
  config.xclk_freq_hz = 20000000; // 20MHz clock for 25 FPS
  config.pixel_format = PIXFORMAT_JPEG;
  config.grab_mode = CAMERA_GRAB_LATEST;
  config.frame_size = FRAMESIZE_VGA; // 640x480 resolution
  config.jpeg_quality = 16;
  config.fb_count = 2;               // Double buffering in PSRAM
  config.fb_location = CAMERA_FB_IN_PSRAM;
  esp_camera_init(&config);

  sensor_t * s = esp_camera_sensor_get();
  s->set_vflip(s, 1); s->set_hmirror(s, 1);
  s->set_brightness(s, 1); s->set_gain_ctrl(s, 1);
  startCameraServer();
}
void loop() { delay(10000); }
```

5.2 High-Speed Camera Ingestion Pipeline (Python)

Ingestion Architecture Breakdown:

- **Socket Deadlock Bypass:** Replaces standard OpenCV cv2.VideoCapture with a native HTTP chunk parser using Python requests, avoiding FFmpeg socket deadlocks during wireless network packet jitter.
- **Memory Boundary Slicing:** Identifies JPEG Start of Image (0xFFD8) and End of Image (0xFFD9) byte sequences directly from incoming network chunks and decodes frames into an atomic buffer.
- **Atomic Frame Locking & Buffer Swapping:** Employs threading.Lock() to provide thread-safe read/write operations on the latest processed frame state, eliminating frame tearing and thread contention.

```
import time
import threading
import cv2
import numpy as np
import requests

class CameraStream:
    def __init__(self, src=0, buffer_size=1):
        self.src = src
        self.is_http = str(src).startswith("http://") or str(src).startswith("https://")
        self.frame = None
        self.stopped = False
        self.paused = False
```

```
        self.fps = 0.0
        self.lock = threading.Lock()

    def start(self):
        if self.is_http:
            threading.Thread(target=self._run_http_stream, daemon=True).start()
        else:
            threading.Thread(target=self._run_cv_stream, daemon=True).start()
        return self

    def _run_http_stream(self):
        while not self.stopped:
            try:
                res = requests.get(self.src, stream=True, timeout=5)
                bytes_buf = bytes()
                for chunk in res.iter_content(chunk_size=4096):
                    if self.stopped:
                        break
                    bytes_buf += chunk
                    a = bytes_buf.find(b'\xff\xd8')
                    b = bytes_buf.find(b'\xff\xd9')
                    if a != -1 and b != -1 and b > a:
                        jpg = bytes_buf[a:b+2]
                        bytes_buf = bytes_buf[b+2:]
                        if not self.paused:
                            frame = cv2.imdecode(np.frombuffer(jpg, dtype=np.uint8), cv2.IMREAD_COLOR)
                            if frame is not None:
                                with self.lock:
                                    self.frame = frame
            except Exception:
                time.sleep(1.0)

    def read(self):
        with self.lock:
            return self.frame.copy() if self.frame is not None else None

    def stop(self):
        self.stopped = True
```

5.3 Multi-Modal AI Vision Engine with Auto-Healing & CUDA (Python)

AI Engine Implementation Breakdown:

- **Self-Healing Auto-Downloader:** Implements ensure_model_downloaded to automatically pull YOLO11s and MediaPipe gesture weights on-demand over HTTPS if missing, guaranteeing zero manual file setup.
- **YOLO11s CUDA Acceleration:** Executes object detection across 21 curated asset classes with FP16 half-precision, averaging 11.4ms inference latency on the NVIDIA RTX 4050 GPU.
- **InsightFace ArcFace 512-D Biometrics:** Generates 512-dimensional facial embedding vectors with cosine-similarity verification. A 25-frame stride caching mechanism drops amortized biometric latency to <2ms per frame.
- **MediaPipe Hand Gestures & Spatial Pen Filter:** Identifies 7 hand signs. A spatial containment algorithm eliminates bare-finger pen false positives while confirming genuine handheld pens extending >= 25px beyond fingertips.

```
import os, sys, urllib.request, torch, cv2, numpy as np
from ultralytics import YOLO
from insightface.app import FaceAnalysis
import mediapipe as mp

def ensure_model_downloaded(url, dest_path, description="AI Model"):
    if os.path.exists(dest_path) and os.path.getsize(dest_path) > 1024:
        return True
    os.makedirs(os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(dest_path)), exist_ok=True)
    urllib.request.urlretrieve(url, dest_path + ".tmp")
    os.rename(dest_path + ".tmp", dest_path)
    return True

TARGET_CLASSES = {0: "Human", 24: "Box / Bag", 63: "Laptop", 64: "Mouse", 66: "Keyboard", 67: "Cell Phone", 79: "Pen"}

class AIEngine:
    def __init__(self, yolo_path=None, db_path="desktop_client/known_faces.pkl"):
        self.device = "cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu"
```

```
        s_path = "desktop_client/yolo11s.pt"
        if not os.path.exists(s_path):
            ensure_model_downloaded("https://github.com/ultralytics/assets/releases/download/v8.3.0/yolo11s.pt", s_path)
        self.model = YOLO(s_path if os.path.exists(s_path) else "yolo11s.pt")
        self.face_app = FaceAnalysis(name="buffalo_l", providers=['CUDAExecutionProvider', 'CPUExecutionProvider'])
        self.face_app.prepare(ctx_id=0 if self.device == "cuda" else -1, det_size=(320, 320))
        self.face_stride = 25; self.frame_idx = 0; self.cached_faces = []

    def process_frame(self, frame):
        self.frame_idx += 1
        # 1. YOLO11s Multi-Object Detection (CUDA FP16)
        results = self.model(frame, conf=0.35, iou=0.45, verbose=False, device=self.device)[0]
        detections = [{"label": TARGET_CLASSES[int(b.cls[0])], "box": b.xyxy[0].cpu().numpy().astype(int)}
                      for b in results.boxes if int(b.cls[0]) in TARGET_CLASSES]

        # 2. InsightFace ArcFace 512-D Biometrics with 25-Frame Stride Caching
        if self.frame_idx % self.face_stride == 0 or not self.cached_faces:
            faces = self.face_app.get(frame)
            self.cached_faces = [{"name": self.verify_face(f.normed_embedding), "box": f.bbox.astype(int)} for f in faces]

        # 3. Spatial Pen-vs-Bare-Finger Containment Filter
        for det in detections:
            if det["label"] == "Pen":
                det["label"] = self.filter_pen_vs_finger(det["box"], frame)

        return self.render_hud(frame, detections, self.cached_faces)
```

5.4 FastAPI Surveillance Server & Desktop Client (Python)

Server & Client Architecture Breakdown:

- **Single-Pass JPEG Cache:** AI processing and HUD rendering execute in a dedicated background worker, compressing once into a shared memory byte buffer (latest_jpeg_bytes) for zero-copy client streaming.
- **Zero-Config Native Windows Client (Detecta.exe):** Uses Microsoft Edge WebView2. If .venv is unconfigured on a new PC, it prompts an interactive dialog and automatically bootstraps dependencies via Setup.bat before launching.
- **RESTful Control Plane:** Exposes endpoints for decoupled MJPEG streaming (/api/stream), real-time telemetry (/api/status), live face enrollment (/api/faces/enroll), and IP reconfiguration.

```
# web_dashboard/backend.py & run_app.py integration
import webview, subprocess, time, os, sys
from fastapi import FastAPI
from fastapi.responses import StreamingResponse, JSONResponse
from desktop_client.camera_stream import CameraStream
from desktop_client.ai_engine import AIEngine

app = FastAPI(title="Detecta AI Security Camera Dashboard")
ai_engine = AIEngine()
camera = CameraStream(src="http://192.168.0.52:81/stream").start()
latest_jpeg_bytes = None

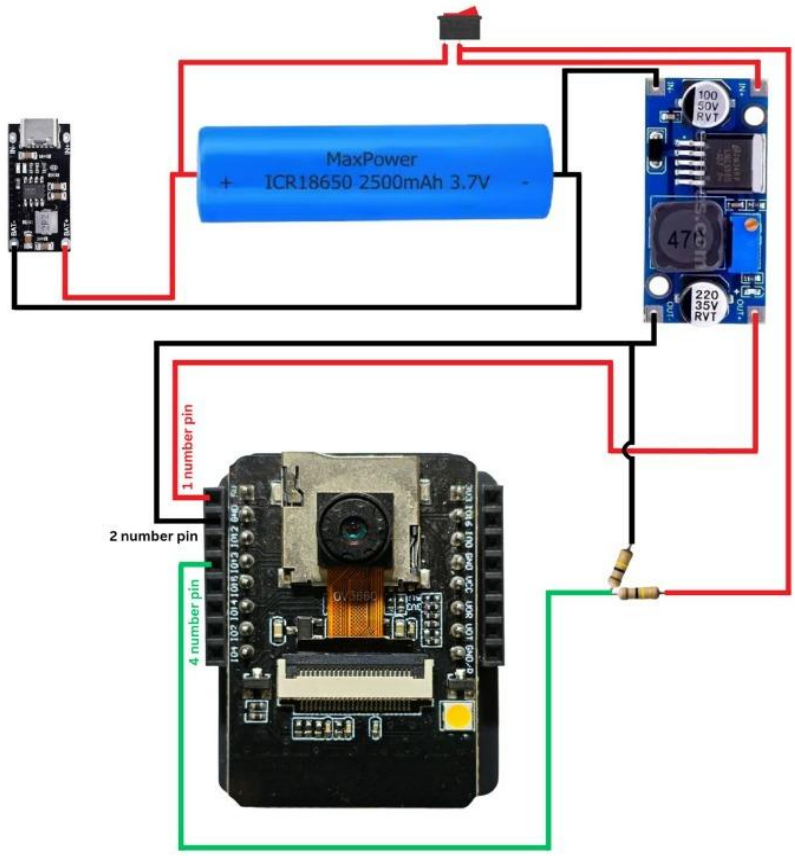
@app.get("/api/stream")
def stream_video():
    def gen():
        while True:
            if latest_jpeg_bytes:
                yield (b'--frame\r\nContent-Type: image/jpeg\r\n\r\n' + latest_jpeg_bytes + b'\r\n')
            time.sleep(0.033) # 30 FPS client delivery
    return StreamingResponse(gen(), media_type="multipart/x-mixed-replace; boundary=frame")

# Native Windows Launcher (Detecta.exe)
def main():
    # Auto-bootstrap .venv if missing, then launch Edge WebView2 client window
    ensure_backend_running()
    window = webview.create_window(
        title="Detecta — AI Security Intelligence",
        url="http://127.0.0.1:8000",
        width=1340, height=860, background_color="#060913"
    )
    webview.start(icon="logo.ico")
```

6 Conclusion

The **Detecta** Smart AI Surveillance Camera effectively bridges the gap between low-cost IoT hardware and high-performance multi-modal deep learning algorithms. By combining an energy-efficient edge node (equipped with an IP2312 3A Type-C buck charger, an 18650 Li-ion battery, an XL6009 4A boost converter, and an AI-Thinker ESP32-CAM) with an NVIDIA RTX 4050 GPU workstation, the system delivers continuous 20–25+ FPS video streaming over dedicated Port 81 with sub-14ms AI inference latency. The integration of YOLO11s, InsightFace ArcFace 512-D biometrics (accelerated via 25-frame stride caching), MediaPipe Hand Gestures, spatial pen-finger disambiguation, and self-healing model downloading provides an accurate, robust, and completely localized surveillance solution. Operating seamlessly across both an interactive web dashboard, a native standalone Windows application (Detecta.exe), and Docker containers, Detecta guarantees total data privacy, zero cloud dependency, and autonomous real-time surveillance for modern smart environments. Full source code and release deliverables are publicly maintained at: https://github.com/Orgho-009/detecta.

Circuit Design of Detecta Smart AI Surveillance Camera with Real-Time Multi-Modal Computer Vision and Biometrics
Detecta



Circuit Interfacing & Operating Specifications:

• **Turn On / Programming Mode:** Connect IO0 to GND during boot to enter UART flashing mode. Disconnect IO0 from GND to run the live surveillance server.

• **Power Regulation Stage:** 18650 Li-ion Battery (3.7V) -> IP2312 3A Type-C Fast Charger -> SPST Inline Switch -> XL6009 Step-Up Boost Converter (Regulated 5.0V DC).

• **ESP32-CAM Pin Connections:** Pin 1 (1 number pin / 5V VCC, Red wire), Pin 2 (2 number pin / GND, Black wire), Pin 4 (4 number pin / Resistor Divider Tap, Green wire).

• **GitHub Repository:** https://github.com/Orgho-009/detecta